Week 9 | Teaching map

December 14 to 18 | Shared work turns a stubborn problem into a result everyone can explain.

Book-centered week

Big Pumpkin | Shared work turns a stubborn problem into a result everyone can explain. Story focus: Retell the complete problem-action-result chain and support it with a page or picture.

Reading and writing

Grade 3

TEKS 3.8C

Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution.

In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved.

TEKS 3.7D

Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order.

In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order.

2026-12-14

Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story.

2026-12-15

Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story.

2026-12-16

Identify the story problem and the action a character takes.

2026-12-17

Retell the important events in order using three picture cards.

2026-12-18

Explain how a character's action changes what happens next.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.8C

Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution.

In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution.

TEKS 4.7C

Use text evidence to support an appropriate response.

In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows.

2026-12-14

Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it.

2026-12-15

Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence.

2026-12-16

Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot.

2026-12-17

Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point.

2026-12-18

Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.

Math

Grade 3

TEKS 3.3H

Compare two fractions having the same numerator or denominator in problems by reasoning about their sizes and justifying the conclusion using symbols, words, objects, and pictorial models.

In plain English: Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator and justify which is greater.

TEKS 3.7D

Determine when it is appropriate to use measurements of liquid volume (capacity) or weight.

In plain English: Decide whether a situation calls for measuring weight or liquid capacity.

TEKS 3.7E

Determine liquid volume (capacity) or weight using appropriate units and tools.

In plain English: Measure weight or liquid capacity with the right tool and units.

2026-12-14

Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why.

2026-12-15

Choose the correct tool, measure a new object or amount of water, and record the number with its unit.

2026-12-16

Choose the correct tool, measure a new object or amount of water, and record the number with its unit.

2026-12-17

Choose the correct tool, measure a new object or amount of water, and record the number with its unit.

2026-12-18

Choose the correct tool, measure a new object or amount of water, and record the number with its unit.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.3A

Represent a fraction a/b as a sum of fractions 1/b, where a and b are whole numbers and b > 0, including when a > b.

In plain English: Build fractions, including amounts greater than one, by adding unit fractions.

TEKS 4.3B

Decompose a fraction in more than one way into a sum of fractions with the same denominator using concrete and pictorial models and recording results with symbolic representations.

In plain English: Break a fraction into same-denominator sums in more than one way; show models and equations.

TEKS 4.3E

Represent and solve addition and subtraction of fractions with equal denominators using objects and pictorial models that build to the number line and properties of operations.

In plain English: Model and solve fraction addition and subtraction with equal denominators.

2026-12-14

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-15

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-16

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-17

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-18

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.

Science

Grade 3

TEKS 3.8A

Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical.

In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

TEKS 3.8B

Plan and conduct investigations that demonstrate how the speed of an object is related to its mechanical energy.

In plain English: Plan and carry out a test connecting an object's speed to its mechanical energy.

2026-12-14

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-15

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-16

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-17

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-18

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.7

Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object.

In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism.

TEKS 4.8A

Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound.

In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy.

2026-12-14

Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer.

2026-12-15

Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer.

2026-12-16

Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer.

2026-12-17

Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer.

2026-12-18

Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.

Social studies

Grade 3

TEKS 3.1A

Describe how individuals, events, and ideas have changed communities, past and present.

In plain English: Explain how people, events and ideas have changed communities.

TEKS 3.9C

Identify and describe individual acts of civic responsibility, including obeying laws, serving and improving the community, serving on a jury, and voting.

In plain English: Describe civic responsibilities such as following laws, helping the community, jury service and voting.

TEKS 3.2B

Compare ways in which people in the local community and other communities meet their needs for government, education, communication, transportation, and recreation.

In plain English: Compare how communities meet needs such as government, education, transportation and recreation.

2026-12-14

Identify a community change caused by people.

2026-12-15

Explain an action that improves a community.

2026-12-16

Compare how two communities meet the same need.

2026-12-17

Plan a helpful action and explain the expected result.

2026-12-18

Show a community problem, action and result.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.3C

Identify leaders important to the founding of Texas as a republic and state, including José Antonio Navarro, Sam Houston, Mirabeau Lamar, and Anson Jones.

In plain English: Identify leaders who helped establish Texas as a republic and a state.

TEKS 4.3D

Describe the successes, problems, and organizations of the Republic of Texas such as the establishment of a constitution, economic struggles, relations with American Indians, and the Texas Rangers.

In plain English: Describe the Republic of Texas's successes, problems and organizations.

TEKS 4.3E

Explain the events that led to the annexation of Texas to the United States and the impact of the U.S.-Mexican War.

In plain English: Explain how Texas became part of the United States and the effects of the U.S.-Mexican War.

2026-12-14

Identify a leader of the Republic of Texas.

2026-12-15

Explain a challenge faced by the Republic.

2026-12-16

Describe one success of the Republic.

2026-12-17

Place annexation in the Texas timeline.

2026-12-18

Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.